

Thesis

Searching for and citing literature

WiSe 2025/26
Prof. Dr. Peter Winker

Searching for and citing literature

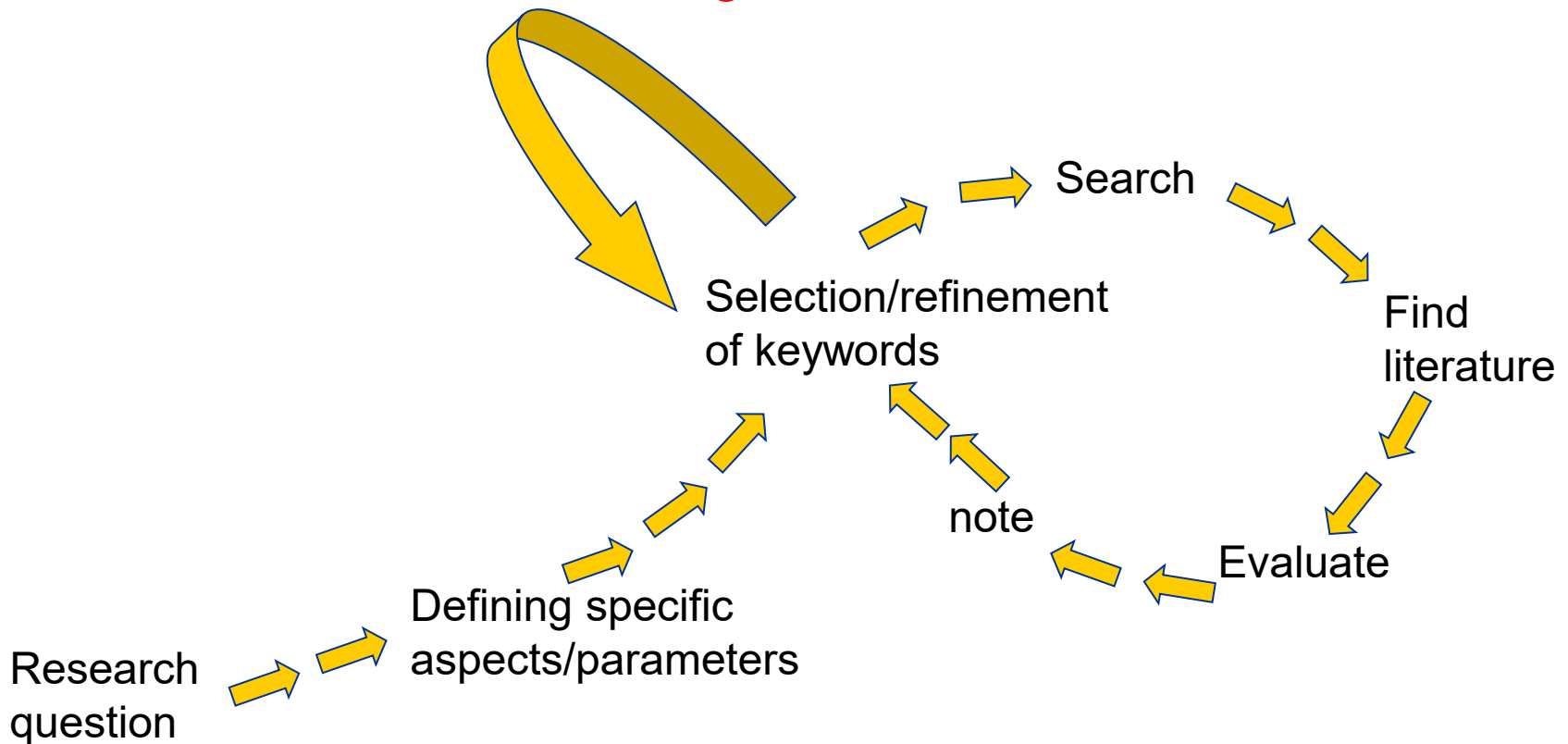
1. Setting a goal
2. Sources for literature searches
3. Search methods and tools
4. Evaluation of sources
5. Citation
6. Summary

1. Setting a goal

- Find and refine a research question
- Identify current state of knowledge
 - Don't reinvent the wheel
 - Find particularly relevant aspects
 - Identify shortcomings in existing approaches
- Identify current research
- Discover connections to other approaches (other disciplines)

Process for literature review

Several rounds during
research work and writing



Contents of the literature review

- Key scientific theories and empirical findings
- Knowledge of the current state of research in the field of work
- Clear and unambiguous references
 - allow the reader to access the original works
 - reduce the risk of plagiarism

Structure of the literature review

- Overview of key ideas and topics
- Summary of the findings of key authors (including comparison)
- Highlight work that is particularly **relevant** to your own project
- Present the results of this work in detail
- In what way/in what area do you want to make new contributions?

Structure

- Goal: Make the approach of your work understandable to readers
- Group arguments
- Set the order of aspects
- Instruments
 - Mind Map
 - List content and connections between content
 - Define main points and subpoints

2. Sources: Literature searches

- Search for literature in the library

2. Sources: Literature searches

- Search for literature in the library
- Internet-based search
 - Quality of sources!

2. Sources: Literature searches

- Search for literature in the library
- Internet-based search
- Databases
 - Use more than one (different coverage)
 - Document search strategy
 - Use logical operators (AND, OR, * etc.)

Overview of literature databases

Business Source Premier (via EBSCO)		
Repec		Focus on economics
Web of Science		Including citations
Google scholar		Including citations

2. Sources: Literature searches

- Search for literature in the library
- Internet-based search
- Databases
- References in already identified relevant literature (past)
 - Identification of key articles
 - Search for overview articles

2. Sources: Literature searches

- Search for literature in the library
- Internet-based search
- Databases
- References in already identified relevant literature (past)
- Citations from already identified relevant literature (future)
 - Cited Reference Search (Screenshots S. 34 ff.)

Access to literature

- University Library Catalog, **JustFind**
- If source is unavailable, search for abstract to identify relevance.
- Interlibrary loan allows access to sources available in other libraries.

Overview availability

Source	Frequency of publication	Availability
(Peer-reviewed) scientific journal	Monthly or quarterly	Many journals available electronically via the university library
Books	One-time (possibly different editions)	Available in the university library, some also as e-books, interlibrary loan if necessary
Conference contributions, discussion papers, etc.	Irregular	Often only available via the Internet – sometimes not permanently
Theses		Often limited availability

3. Search methods and tools

- Limiting search parameters
- Selection of **keywords**
- Selection of **databases**
- Search procedure
- Criteria for determining relevant sources

Search parameters

- Language of publication
 - English / German
 - Other languages?
- Field(s) of expertise
 - Especially for interdisciplinary questions
- Publication period
 - Only current publications?
- Type of source

Keywords

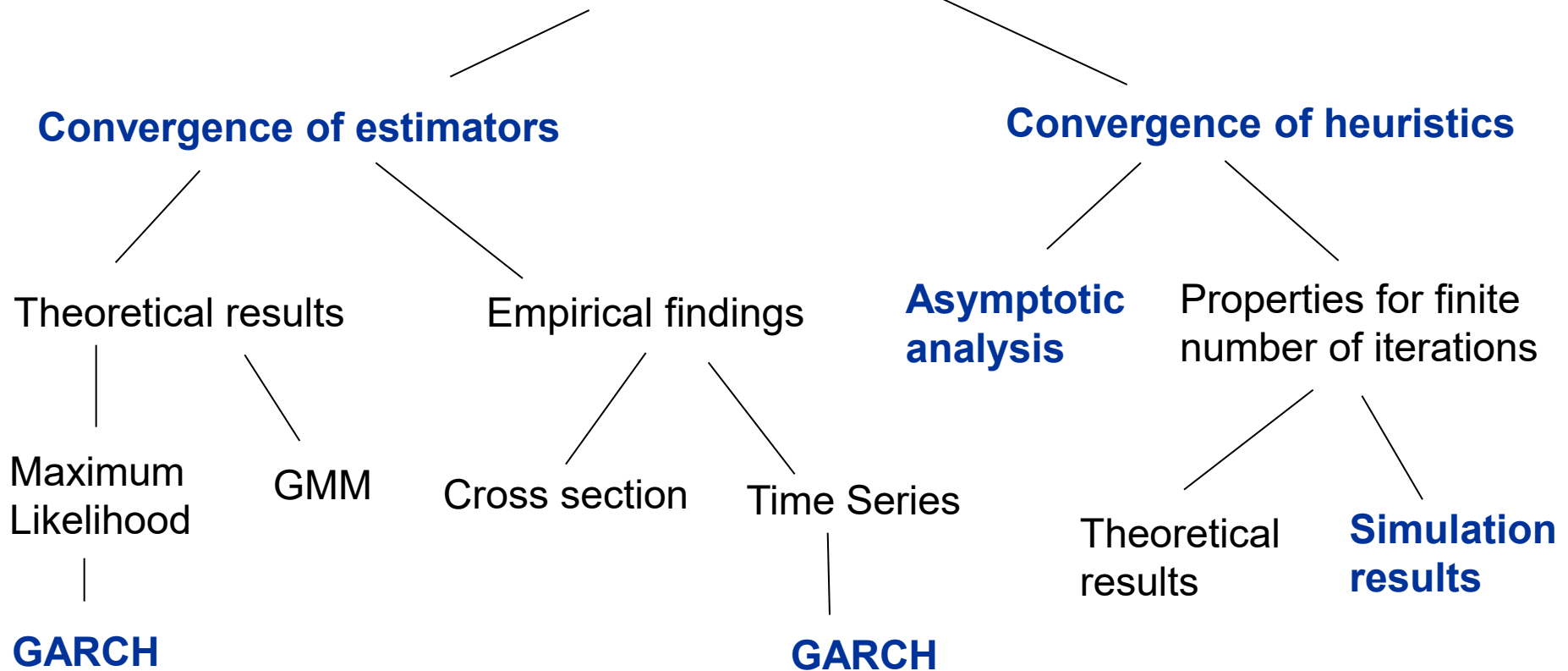
- Sources for keywords
 - Introductory reading
 - Überblicksartikel und Dissertationen
 - Gespräche mit Wissenschaftlern
 - Brainstorming
- Organization of keywords, e.g. with the help of „relevance trees“

Relevance Trees

- Graphical method for structuring literature searches
- Starting point: Research topic/question
- Next level: Relevant fields
- Further levels: Subdivision into relevant subtopics with increasing precision
- Highlight areas of **particular relevance** to your own question

Example of a „relevance tree“

How to combine convergence results for ML-estimators (GARCH) and heuristic optimization algorithms (TA)?



4. Evaluation of sources

- Scope of the literature review
 - All sources closely related to the specific topic
 - For completely new subject areas, only loosely related literature may be available
 - ⇒ Expansion of the overview
 - Where possible, reference should also be made to more comprehensive overview articles/dissertations, etc.

Relevance

- Publication date / original work?
- Are there any **more recent** articles on this topic? (cited reference search S. 34 ff.)?
- Is the topic close enough?
- Is the connection comparable?
- Was the source also cited in other relevant articles?
- Does the source either support or contradict the research topic?

Quality

- Distorted representation (selective selection of examples and data)
- Methodological weaknesses (small samples, sample selection, few repetitions, etc.)
- Precision of arguments and results
- Notes for future research?
- Journal ranking (relevance, impact factor)

5. Citation

Journal article	Book	Chapter in edited volume
Author(s) – Last name, initials of first name(s)	Author(s) – Last name, initials of first name(s)	Author(s) – Last name, initials of first name(s)
Year of publication	Year of publication	Year of publication
Title of the article	Title of the book	Title of the chapter
Name of the journal	Possible series name	Author(s) of the book – Last name, initials of first name(s)
Volume/Issue number	Publisher	Title of the book
Page number	Location	Possible series name
		Publisher, Location
		Page numbers of the chapter

5. Citation

- Journal article

Diagram illustrating the components of a journal article citation:

Chamley, C. P. (1986), Optimal taxation of capital income in general equilibrium with infinite lives, *Econometrica* 54, 607–622.

Labels and brackets indicate the structure:

- Last name, Initials: Chamley, C. P.
- Year: (1986)
- Title: Optimal taxation of capital income in general equilibrium with infinite lives
- Name of the journal: *Econometrica*
- Page numbers: 54, 607–622
- Volume/Issue: 54 (indicated by an arrow from the page numbers bracket)

- Book

Diagram illustrating the components of a book citation:

Atkinson, A. B. and J. E. Stiglitz (1980), *Lectures on Public Economics*, McGraw-Hill, London and New York.

Labels and brackets indicate the structure:

- Last name, Initials: Atkinson, A. B. and J. E. Stiglitz
- Year: (1980)
- Title of the book: *Lectures on Public Economics*
- Publisher: McGraw-Hill
- Location: London and New York

5. Citation

- Internet source

Website owner, where appropriate author of the article (Year), Title of the article, URL (accessed on ...)

Additional notes

- Other important information that should be noted/stored:
 - Keywords and brief summary
 - Relevant quotations, including page number(s)
 - Reference (University Library, Internet...)
 - Database and search procedure
 - Your assessment of quality
 - Date of access (particularly for internet sources)

6. Summary

1. Define research questions and objectives
2. Generate keywords and search terms
3. Begin the search using databases and references/citations
4. Broaden the search by skimming
5. Obtain texts and take notes
6. Start developing an overview as **early** as possible
7. Continue searching to refine and keep the overview up to date

Tips for the writing phase

- Write one paragraph every day.
- Choose manageable writing goals
 - Integrate free writing phases
- Avoid nested sentences
- Avoid stuffy writing: use short words, verbs instead of nouns
 - the vast majority of → **the majority**
- Write in active and avoid passiv

Submission Guidelines

- **All** literature used must be submitted in electronic form. (.pdf-files in JLU-Box)
- Exceptions:
 - Books available at Giessen University Library
 - Books obtained through interlibrary loan (location must be specified)
 - Journal articles that can be accessed online via the University Library of Giessen

Further reading

- B. Wilmer: Literaturbeschaffung in den Wirtschaftswissenschaften, Foliensatz.
- B. Sandberg: Wissenschaftliches Arbeiten von Abbildung bis Zitat, De Gruyter, Berlin 2017 (3. Aufl.)
- M. Saunders, P. Lewis, A. Thornhill: Research Methods for Business Students, Prentice Hall , Harlow 2007 (4th edition), Chapter 3.

Learning paths

- <https://www.econbiz.de/eb/de/wissenschaftlich-arbeiten/lernpfade>
- Website offers interactive training courses, videos, and other materials on the topic of scientific work

END



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And Cited Work Example: adv* food* res* AZ

And Cited Year(s) Example: 2013-2014

+ Add row + Add date range

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- Example: enter “Winker P*” for author and “1999” for year

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And Cited Work Example: adv* food* res* AZ

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4 Cited References

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☐	Cited Author	Cited Work	Title	Year	Volume	Issue	Page	Identifier	Citing Articles
☐	Smolny, W.; Winker, P. ▾	IVS DISCUSSION PAPER ▾	Employment adjustment and financing constraints-a theoretical and empirical analysis at the micro level	1999	573				1
☐	Winker, P. ▾	APPL ECON ▾	Sluggish adjustment of interest rates and credit rationing: an application of unit root testing and error correction modelling	1999	31	3	267-277	10.1080/000368499324255	17
☐	WINKER P. ▾	IN PRESS SMALL BUSIN ▾		1999					2
☐	Winker, P. ▾	SMALL BUS ECON ▾	Causes and effects of financing constraints at the firm level	1999	12	2	169-181	10.1023/A:1008035826914	60

Page size 50 ▾ < 1 of 1 >

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Causes and effects of financing constraints at the firm level

By Winker, P (Winker, P)
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Source SMALL BUSINESS ECONOMICS
Volume: 12 Issue: 2 Page: 169-181
DOI: 10.1023/A:1008035826914

Published MAR 1999

Indexed 1999-03-01

Document Type Article

Abstract
This paper focuses on the empirical assessment of determinants and effects of financing constraints at the firm level. Using a standard model of credit rationing based on asymmetric information firm age and size are found to be factors which should influence the probability of financing constraints. Improving business conditions strengthen the degree of informational asymmetry. A unique panel of firm data for Germany, including direct information on financing constraints, is used for the econometric analysis. Firms' size and improving business conditions are found to have a significant effect. Furthermore, a significant impact on investment and R&D expenditures cannot be rejected.

Keywords
Keywords Plus: GERMAN BANKS DIFFERENT; MANUFACTURING-INDUSTRIES; INVESTMENT; INTERMEDIATION; FLUCTUATIONS; BEHAVIOR; MARKETS; GROWTH; PANEL

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- ☐ Early Access 1

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1 Do financial constraints lead to environmental, social and governance controversies? The role of country context

Vargas-Santander, KG; Alvarez-Diez, S; (...); Belda-Ruiz, M

Jan 2025 | BUSINESS STRATEGY AND THE ENVIRONMENT 34 (1), pp.965-981

[Enriched Cited References](#)

The term sustainability and environmental, social and governance (ESG) criteria has gained greater importance globally in recent decades. As social and environmental issues increase, firms are advocating the need to be more sustainable. However, in this scenario, corporate controversies still persist, and an analysis of their causes is required. This study ... [Show more](#)

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1 Citation
111 References

2 Financial constraints for R&D and innovation: new evidence from a survey experiment

Czarnitzki, D and Giebel, M

Oct 2024 (Early Access) | APPLIED ECONOMICS

[Enriched Cited References](#)

We utilize a survey experiment to evaluate the existence and degree of financial constraints for R&D. The experiment not only allows for the deduction of the presence of financial constraints but also for evaluating their economic significance. Using data on German companies, we find that financial constraints exist, but their relevance might have been over ... [Show more](#)

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65 References

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The screenshot shows a Web of Science article page. The main article is titled "Causes and effects of financing constraints at the firm level" by Winker, P. The article is from the journal "SMALL BUSINESS ECONOMICS", Volume 12, Issue 2, Page 169-181, published in March 1999. The abstract discusses the empirical assessment of determinants and effects of financing constraints at the firm level. The keywords include GERMAN BANKS DIFFERENT; MANUFACTURING-INDUSTRIES; INVESTMENT; INTERMEDIATION; FLUCTUATIONS; BEHAVIOR; MARKETS; GROWTH; PANEL.

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Causes and effects of financing constraints at the firm level

By Winker, P (Winker, P)
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Source SMALL BUSINESS ECONOMICS
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☐ 2022

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☐ 2021

1,466

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1

Investment, Q and liquidity - Evidence for Germany using firm level balance sheet data

Behr, A

Jan 2005 | JAHRBUCHER FUR NATIONALOKONOMIE UND STATISTIK ▾ 225 (1) , pp.2-21

We analyse the investment behaviour of German firms within the framework of the Q-theory. Because we use anonymous individual firm balance sheet data, no stock market measure of Q is available. The data set contains 1,342 manufacturing firms covering the period 1987 to 1998. Using the approach of Abel&Blanchard and Gilchrist&Himmelberg ... Show more ▾

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Capital-market imperfections and investment

Hubbard, RG

Mar 1998 | JOURNAL OF ECONOMIC LITERATURE ▾ 36 (1) , pp.193-225

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103

References

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